

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 34

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "REVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

Heaven rejoices when we start to practice KF Confession 8:

We co-labor with the Creator to seek and to save that which was lost.

Our Bible passages for this lesson are taken from chapter 15 of the Gospel of John and chapter 3 of First Peter. Let's start with Nancy's paraphrase of selected verses from **John 15:1–11**, where Jesus is speaking.

¹I and no other am the True Vine, and my Father is the farmer. ²All the branches attached to Me that are not bearing fruit He takes away, and all the branches that are bearing fruit He prunes back so that they can carry more fruit. . . . ⁴In all of your activities, remain in Me, even as I am remaining in you. Just as the branch must remain connected to the vine in order to bear fruit, so you must remain connected to Me. . . . ⁸You become My disciples by bearing much fruit and through this My Father is honored by others. ⁹Just as the Father is well-pleased with Me, I am well-pleased with you. Live in My love. ¹⁰If you guard My commands, you will remain in My love, just as I have guarded My Father's commands and remain in His love. ¹¹I have told you these things so that you might experience My joy and that your joy might be complete.

1. Jesus is the True Vine

Jesus calls Himself the True Vine. This implies that there are false vines, and Nancy would call these false vines the Idol Self. The True Self is a branch connected to the True Vine, but sometimes that branch doesn't seem to be producing much fruit. Have you ever seen a grapevine that has been pruned for winter? At this dormant stage of its life cycle, the vine is unproductive and unattractive. From a distance the vine looks dead, and you would swear that it could never produce fruit again. We might feel that way about ourselves. But if you understand the growth cycle of the vine, you will know that the vine is not dead. It is quietly enduring the winter while it secretly and mysteriously recharges and prepares to produce abundant fruit in the spring.

2. We glorify the Father by bearing much fruit

How do we glorify the Father? We glorify the Father by bearing much fruit. The Fruit of the Spirit is something that people see, and when they see this fruit in us, they recognize the character of the True Vine.

3. We abide in the love of Jesus through obedience

The life force of the True Vine is love. If we remain in the Vine, we have access to this life current of love, which, like breath, flows in and through us in harmony with God and the Creation. In this state of harmony, we can do astonishing things. How do we stay attached to the Vine? We stay attached to the Vine by abiding in His love, and we abide in His love through obedience.

Now let's flip over to **First Peter 3:8–12**, which we will read in Nancy's paraphrase.

Here is a summary of what I have just been saying: All of you, be like loving family—harmonious, compassionate, tender-hearted, and humble in spirit. ⁹Get into a healthy cycle by blessing others instead of perpetuating a destructive cycle by returning harm for harm and punishing others to restore your hurt pride. Look at it this way. You were invited into karis relationship with God in order that you might inherit a blessing from God. This is karis circulation. Therefore, your choice to bless others does not depend on what they do or don't do. That is how law-keepers live. ¹⁰Do you remember Psalm 34? "Those who desire to live well, and to love and experience good days, reveal that intention by refusing to speak the harm on the tip of their tongues and by refusing to use polite words to cloak resentful wrath. Those who choose life take responsibility for their feelings. They choose to swerve away from harming the Creation and do good to themselves and to others. They seek for peace as for something lost, and they pursue it like a hunter. ¹²Why? Because the eyes of the Lord are toward the oriented and His ears attend to their prayer, but the face of the Lord is actively against those who perpetuate misorientation."

Take a deep breath.

God has invited you into a karis relationship with Him so that you can inherit His blessing. You can't inherit His blessing if you continue to live life your own way, taking cheap, habitual shortcuts to relieve your anxiety and save your Idol's pride. By consistently following Peter's short list of do's and don'ts, you continue to invest in your stock portfolio of blessing, which in due season will produce abundant and glorious fruit.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Lord of blessing, whatever it takes, bring me into my inheritance of blessing. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for this time together of healing and redirection. Hold us in this orientation toward You and toward our inheritance. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our true design and potential, with our community and the Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.